

FORGE-X Investigation Report

DEMO-Corp-Breach-2026 — full report

Target	workstation-07.demo.lab (WINDOWS)	Source mode	DATASET
Provenance	SYNTHETIC	Generated	2026-09-27T12:44:47.193357+00:00
Report type	FULL	Author	admin
Evidence items	33	Findings	0

NOTE: This case was generated from SYNTHETIC sample data for demonstration. It is not real-world evidence.

1. Evidence Summary

Type	Count
FILE	3
NETWORK_CONNECTION	10
PROCESS	4
SYSTEM_EVENT	13
USER_ACCOUNT	3

Evidence integrity (SHA-256 anchor chain): VALID

33 anchor records · SHA-256 append-only ledger (full per-record recompute)

2. Findings

No findings recorded.

3. AI Incident Reconstruction

Engine: HEURISTIC · Model: forges-correlation-engine-v1 · Confidence: 0.9

What happened: Correlated 33 evidence items into 6 attack stages (Initial Access → Execution → Persistence → Command and Control → Exfiltration → Lateral Movement). [Initial Access] Repeated authentication failures against account 'svc_backup' consistent with password guessing. [Execution] Obfuscated command line executed by powershell.exe. [Persistence] Scheduled task 'UpdaterSvc' created pointing to C:\Temp\updater.exe [Command and Control] Outbound connection to 203.0.113.9:4444 on a port commonly used by remote access tooling.

- Initial Access:** Repeated authentication failures against account 'svc_backup' consistent with password guessing. (evidence: 09854d4f, 2375ce28, 2703db95, 318cee5e, 447dcfe5, 88b5e798, acab2e46, bbc6c580, bea7faf4, f0e53d5b)
- Execution:** Obfuscated command line executed by powershell.exe. (evidence: 09854d4f, 46a1bd8b, 8b7ad367)
- Persistence:** Scheduled task 'UpdaterSvc' created pointing to C:\Temp\updater.exe (evidence: d7c8cc5d)
- Command and Control:** Outbound connection to 203.0.113.9:4444 on a port commonly used by remote access tooling. (evidence: 0bf19afa, 2da484b1, 30c78e63, 9ed7ebd5, cdba0d76, df27c976)
- Exfiltration:** High-volume outbound transfer to 203.0.113.9 consistent with data exfiltration. (evidence: 2da484b1, 30c78e63)

- **Lateral Movement:** Connection to remote administrative service on 198.51.100.23. (*evidence: e174c658*)

MITRE ATT&CK mapping: T1110 (Brute Force), T1078 (Valid Accounts), T1059.001 (PowerShell), T1204.002 (User Execution: Malicious File), T1105 (Ingress Tool Transfer), T1204.001 (User Execution: Malicious Link), T1571 (Non-Standard Port), T1048 (Exfiltration Over Alternative Protocol), T1021 (Remote Services), T1071.004 (Application Layer Protocol: DNS), T1547.001 (Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder)

Analysis gaps: No memory artifacts — in-memory activity cannot be confirmed.

4. Investigation Timeline (first 120 entries)

Timestamp	Type	Severity	Description
2026-09-26T10:00:20	PROCESS	INFO	outlook.exe (PID 2200) spawned by explorer.exe (svc_backup)
2026-09-26T10:00:30	FILE	INFO	C:\Users\svc_backup\Documents\Q3-financials.xlsx written/observed (1048576 bytes)
2026-09-26T10:02:12	SYSTEM_EVENT	MEDIUM	[login_failure] Failed password for svc_backup from 198.51.100.23 port 5000 ssh2
2026-09-26T10:03:12	SYSTEM_EVENT	MEDIUM	[login_failure] Failed password for svc_backup from 198.51.100.23 port 5010 ssh2
2026-09-26T10:04:12	SYSTEM_EVENT	MEDIUM	[login_failure] Failed password for svc_backup from 198.51.100.23 port 5020 ssh2
2026-09-26T10:05:12	SYSTEM_EVENT	MEDIUM	[login_failure] Failed password for svc_backup from 198.51.100.23 port 5030 ssh2
2026-09-26T10:06:12	SYSTEM_EVENT	MEDIUM	[login_failure] Failed password for svc_backup from 198.51.100.23 port 5040 ssh2
2026-09-26T10:07:12	SYSTEM_EVENT	MEDIUM	[login_failure] Failed password for svc_backup from 198.51.100.23 port 5050 ssh2
2026-09-26T10:08:12	SYSTEM_EVENT	MEDIUM	[login_failure] Failed password for svc_backup from 198.51.100.23 port 5060 ssh2
2026-09-26T10:09:12	SYSTEM_EVENT	MEDIUM	[login_failure] Failed password for svc_backup from 198.51.100.23 port 5070 ssh2
2026-09-26T10:12:44	SYSTEM_EVENT	LOW	[login_success] Accepted password for svc_backup from 198.51.100.23 port 5911 ssh2
2026-09-26T10:13:30	SYSTEM_EVENT	HIGH	[privilege_use] sudo: svc_backup : command=/usr/bin/install -m 755 updater.exe /tmp/updater.exe
2026-09-26T10:13:40	FILE	MEDIUM	C:\Temp\updater.exe written/observed (482304 bytes)
2026-09-26T10:14:10	PROCESS	HIGH	powershell.exe (PID 4567) spawned by outlook.exe (svc_backup)
2026-09-26T10:14:10	SYSTEM_EVENT	INFO	[process_create] Process created: powershell.exe -enc JABwAHIAbwBjACAAPQAg...
2026-09-26T10:15:00	PROCESS	INFO	updater.exe (PID 4600) spawned by powershell.exe (svc_backup)
2026-09-26T10:15:02	SYSTEM_EVENT	HIGH	[persistence] Scheduled task 'UpdaterSvc' created pointing to C:\Temp\updater.exe
2026-09-26T10:16:10	FILE	INFO	C:\Temp\data.zip written/observed (5242880 bytes)
2026-09-26T10:16:15	PROCESS	HIGH	curl.exe (PID 4700) spawned by updater.exe (svc_backup)
2026-09-26T10:16:20	SYSTEM_EVENT	INFO	[network_connect] Windows Filter Platform permitted connection to 203.0.113.9:4444
2026-09-27T12:44:45	NETWORK_CONNECTION	HIGH	10.0.0.5:49152 → 203.0.113.9:4444 (TCP)
2026-09-27T12:44:45	NETWORK_CONNECTION	INFO	10.0.0.5:51234 → 198.51.100.23:22 (TCP)
2026-09-27T12:44:45	NETWORK_CONNECTION	INFO	10.0.0.5:52000 → 10.0.0.7:445 (TCP)
2026-09-27T12:44:45	NETWORK_CONNECTION	INFO	10.0.0.5:53001 → 10.0.0.2:53 (UDP) dns=cdn-update.ngrok.io
2026-09-27T12:44:45	NETWORK_CONNECTION	HIGH	10.0.0.5:49152 → 203.0.113.9:4444 (TCP)
2026-09-27T12:44:45	NETWORK_CONNECTION	INFO	198.51.100.23:5911 → 10.0.0.5:22 (TCP)
2026-09-27T12:44:45	USER_ACCOUNT	INFO	User account svc_backup (last login 2026-09-26T10:02:10+00:00)
2026-09-27T12:44:45	USER_ACCOUNT	INFO	User account j.alice (last login 2026-09-26T10:00:05+00:00)
2026-09-27T12:44:45	USER_ACCOUNT	INFO	User account root (last login 2026-09-26T10:00:01+00:00)

Timestamp	Type	Severity	Description
2026-09-29T18:12:44	NETWORK_CONNECTIONNFO		198.51.100.23:5911 → 10.0.0.5:22 (TCP)
2026-09-29T18:16:10	NETWORK_CONNECTIONNFO		10.0.0.5:53001 → 10.0.0.2:53 (UDP) dns=cdn-update.ngrok.io
2026-09-29T18:16:20	NETWORK_CONNECTIONHIGH		10.0.0.5:49152 → 203.0.113.9:4444 (TCP)
2026-09-29T18:16:21	NETWORK_CONNECTIONHIGH		10.0.0.5:49152 → 203.0.113.9:4444 (TCP)

5. Chain of Custody / Audit

When	Actor	Action	Result
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Evidence hashes (first 40):

804d56a8... PROCESS sha256:12f9cd02ee00d6a5b30330f9289bfe3b7826619d61ffbbcaa462a97855dd2223
09854d4f... PROCESS sha256:dfc0722b8cba2964963d7d67c0fe01f723c7585baf58b063d74a4b4a09fb5ac7
8b7ad367... PROCESS sha256:02902a4f644317fa8c2d38268cb1723a2652af57a256a18baa26e221ad5ce093
f9bca853... PROCESS sha256:6ead899d1ef229277509f49404c6ad9658f333b2d74fe1fb1d239a0b8dbac4e7
46a1bd8b... FILE sha256:fccc3edfbd0c33875805bfc8dc65d02bf9d0d31adbf9dead97c643d1bf7116
f07bdab4... FILE sha256:d088528155c9ee1f506d2fddf81f08c871ae9caa2b3e97b21988f9bfa35dd3bc
645bea78... FILE sha256:036a5337bb9ea476357f95b71ee17f10115d42a71f95203beaaf8ca93ecaf06d
30c78e63... NETWORK_CONNECTION
sha256:103a815dab2d6b855adb5fd29bffc9cd317c64ba964c57fa9a586997161a6f4d
e174c658... NETWORK_CONNECTION
sha256:a74dc805a95b6377f759a3758accb2d8caa47578dd4637bdf5dd1a52b908d68a
7fc1feb6... NETWORK_CONNECTION
sha256:64a4dadfffd4a24be5c0acafade420b56e373abaae4167c16582859c2cab0743
df27c976... NETWORK_CONNECTION
sha256:c07b98919aa4e8242720a14f4484f1242851605ff64c86d33bafdd06b1cf5cbd
2da484b1... NETWORK_CONNECTION
sha256:21902a3aa86a0f23f147a494233fb6f6bf44fcbe5b884f62041e8d88d4dec0cf
8d7c180b... NETWORK_CONNECTION
sha256:6ed903cc36cc6568269506d54a5b2ccd338ba1ea46d117c8d4b001e13c39f702
9ed7ebd5... NETWORK_CONNECTION
sha256:9f69c9dd28663fc62e5bc160a6a92308c8656d3637b072fbe42c71a6a5aaa77f
cdba0d76... NETWORK_CONNECTION
sha256:95c332f66ddacb37dea20a720011a6fdefc1c01351ea87a421223c075541e9c6
0bf19afa... NETWORK_CONNECTION
sha256:4e901917e40cf9d45746843c5f428edbe5deb89b6fe2ca1effea501beb1bbbae
e595e0db... NETWORK_CONNECTION
sha256:95338a805abcf97d91fc2a5bf0684aaeeb85226511c115c144165f71db94fba6
50451184... USER_ACCOUNT sha256:6a3fc35ee7a1a97b717dd462441bc5aa88d8859fdc2cb0891b7ebab43ee2c2f3
2741d487... USER_ACCOUNT sha256:f43735b0f573c3f638163cee6694e951ba4ac1d49d9079077affe81ab3972786
1ab81f2b... USER_ACCOUNT sha256:cfe5ae97cf50a8fa082ae9b8471764dbb9cb057d51d52ff9ac020e46ea789035
acab2e46... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:24b436747482d4c9f93ccd088de6096e4a5e611a29f1bc9d577e22fda719ed2d
318cee5e... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:61573a067b3c1d0ee4d0dd130309caf1557ecb17886d5251acf3ca3a50a30de8
bea7faf4... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:913de2126159c8763dff7c50c7748a5d7d92a6a45b3b043046810ba09730109b
2703db95... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:829713ba9d850bf2c24b7c6eb20c1b590a9d4019ed86946540daba8f47fad998
447dcfe5... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:9734a2ced134089c849568868ce15aaffee7c98a3263d2385d5badf967864a30
bbc6c580... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:1582d187fffaaf602debabcc19085e8780505ef4450acac5c1b22c402a832a3c
2375ce28... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:4ae3d8afae937896f0794b8063ab3037eb3601d144a95d0442df81cb5c30549c
f0e53d5b... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:35b59001ed6a0ff0ab2e4d94ed96f0e9e171069887b0d18641a5626575aedd85
88b5e798... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:7b7d9b0006bfd9ed59680159e9b6922a0cd39f34ec49a7c9b2f52ae4819cd67a
2396f7d1... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:ea60e7e4a03ece79d6211d64d27244f4bb855f720403855c67f5464e17ffe097
d7c8cc5d... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:aeb56ade0b6f846ac55bbb3397d823102cab21ab800f51f84a97a8473643892
154ae508... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:fccaa256b4dcde9cb71cfa93a028a6a631d848769c58e88d81e5090456f8f843
f002bac1... SYSTEM_EVENT sha256:fb0c3ce46ad7ba7b05398c32ea61c2e48e22af6170212a4b41fb4d89d8915f14